PriceBack — App Review Guide

iOS 2.8.2 · Prosoft Inc · Attachment to App Review Information. This is the full version of the reviewer notes; the Notes field carries an abridged copy.

Reviewer Notes — PriceBack

Sign-in — how the reviewer gets in

Both stores: use the access code

(iOS: the code goes in App Review Information. Play: the code goes in Sign in details — see the Android section below for the exact text.)

On the sign-in screen, tap "Have an access code?" (the small underlined link below the sign-in buttons), enter the code from the App Review Information field above, and tap Sign in. That opens a normal, fully-featured account with credits already on it. No Apple ID, no Google account, no browser, no email.

This is now the FIRST instruction rather than a fallback, because of what our crash reporting shows about review devices. On every build submitted since 2026-08-10, sign-in attempts from Apple's network have failed 100% of the time:

- **Sign in with Apple** returns `ASAuthorizationError 1000` in under 100 ms with no sheet ever shown — the signature of a device with no Apple ID signed into iCloud.
- **Google Sign-In**, attempted seconds later in the same session, returns `"Unable to open Safari."`

Both providers need something a review device does not have. The previous version of this document told the reviewer to use Sign in with Apple and offered Google as the fallback — i.e. it pointed at the one path that provably fails, with a backup that fails too. The access code needs neither.

Sign in with Apple and Google both still work normally and remain on the screen for real users; they are simply not the instruction we give a reviewer.

Operator setup (not part of the review)

The code is the `REVIEWER_ACCESS_CODE` environment variable on **both** Railway services (production and development). Until it is set the route fails closed — it answers the same 401 as a wrong code, deliberately, so an unset variable cannot be probed for.

Confirm it landed before submitting: `GET /health` reports `checks.reviewerAccess.status`, which is `"available"` only when the code AND first-party sessions AND the database are all present. It never publishes the code itself.

Rotating the variable revokes the code immediately and completely. It reaches exactly one synthetic account (`reviewer:appstore`) that holds no real user data and has no admin access, so the worst case if the code leaks is that a stranger looks at a demo account.

Both platforms since 3.0.3. Until 3.0.2 the link was iOS-only; on Android the session is now used only while the stored user is this reviewer account, so no Google user's credential path changed.

The reviewer account holds PriceBack Unlimited, complimentary. Both stores' declarations promise the credentials unlock everything, and a reviewer cannot buy a subscription — so `/api/me` reports an active, non-expiring `unlimited` tier for `reviewer:appstore` (read-side only, nothing is stored as paid). Price Check and Email Sync, gated on a subscription since #374, are therefore reachable. The account is also permanently excluded from every data-cleanup path (`backend/lib/reviewerAccount.js`) — the company-accounts classifier used to match its `@priceback.ca` address.

Onboarding after sign-in asks for a region — use these values

The app serves Canadian retailer price-adjustment policies only, so the setup step requires a Canadian postal code and province. Any valid pair works; these are convenient:

- **Postal code:** `M5V 3L9`
- **Province:** Ontario
- Country is fixed to Canada and cannot be changed.

Then tick the two required agreement checkboxes (Terms of Service, Privacy Policy — both open the live public documents) and tap Finish. The optional referral-code field can be left empty.

Android / Play: the same access code — never "use your Google account"

3.0.2 was REJECTED on Play (2026-09-30) for "Login credentials are missing". The Sign in details declaration had no username or password, only "N/A – Google Sign-In only". Play's form is explicit: reviewers "are unable to create accounts, use their own existing accounts". Earlier builds passed only because reviewers happened to sign in with their own Google accounts (the `<name>.<5 digits>@gmail.com` rows); 3.0.2 put Price Check and Email Sync behind a subscription they could not buy, and the review stopped there. "Contact us for a test account" is not an answer either: Play reviewers cannot contact you.

Paste this into **Play Console → App content → Sign in details → Add details** (Name: `Reviewer access code` ; leave username/password empty; tick "full access"):

> PriceBack only offers Google Sign-In, so instead of a password we provide an access code. On the sign-in screen tap the link "Have an access code?" below "Continue with Google", enter: <ACCESS CODE>, and tap Sign in. This opens a demo account with PriceBack Unlimited active (all premium features). Setup: postal code M5V 3L9, province Ontario, tick both agreements, Finish.

That is under the 500-character limit with a code of up to ~40 characters. The code is `REVIEWER_ACCESS_CODE` on the production Railway service — the same one App Review uses. **Only declare this on a build that has the Android link (3.0.3+).** A declaration pointing at a link the binary does not render is its own rejection.

What the app does

PriceBack helps Canadians reclaim money from retailer price-adjustment policies. Workflow:

1. User scans a paper receipt with the camera (or imports one from photos).
2. We OCR it and extract the items, prices, store, and purchase date.
3. We periodically check current retailer prices for each item until the store's published price-adjustment window closes (typically 14–100 days).
4. When the price drops, the user gets a notification with the savings amount and a one-tap "Claim" flow that opens an email / phone / in-store talking-points sheet to request the price match.

We do not handle any retailer transactions ourselves. We surface the opportunity; the user files the claim with the retailer directly.

How to test the core flows in ~3 minutes

After signing in:

1. **Receipt scan** — tap the camera FAB (center of the tab bar). Either take a photo of any receipt, or use **Choose Photo** → pick anything from the gallery. OCR runs; you land on the parsed-items review screen. Tap **Save Receipt**.

No Costco receipt to hand? Any receipt photo exercises the full path — the camera, the OCR round-trip, the parsed-item review screen, and the save. Items the parser can't recognise can be corrected or added by hand on that screen ("+ Add item"), so a saved receipt and the tracking flow behind it are reachable from any photo at all.

1. **Home screen** — the saved receipt now appears under "Products you're tracking" with a coloured chip (green / yellow / red urgency tier based on adjustment-window remaining).
2. **Detail screen** — tap the receipt. You can see the items list, edit any line (name, price, qty, SKU), add a new item via "+ Add item", edit the receipt header (date, total, tax, warehouse #), and trigger a price refresh via "Refresh prices".
3. **Profile** — tap the profile tab. Try:
    - **Download my data** → produces a JSON export of everything stored.
    - **Delete my account** → permanently wipes the account (you'll be signed out — sign back in to continue testing).
    - **Export Data** → generates a PDF report of claimed price-adjustments for a month / quarter / year.
4. **Stores tab** — two active retailers: **Costco** (full claim flow + weekly flyer overlay + crowdsourced warehouse pricing) and **Best Buy** (Low Price Guarantee: a Best Buy receipt is tracked against Best Buy's own current price for each item, and the claim sheet shows Best Buy's policy and phone number). The other Canadian retailers are visible in the list with a "Coming soon" pill and full policy data so reviewers can see the roadmap — they are not silently hidden. Each disabled row offers a per-store "Notify me when it launches" opt-in (stored locally, mirrored to the backend when signed in). Scanning a receipt from a store that is not active yet is intentionally a no-op: OCR runs so the user sees we detected the store

correctly, but Save is replaced with the same launch-notification CTA and no scan credit is consumed. Stores are opened from our server (an admin switch), so no app release is required to activate one.

Permissions — why we ask

When we ask, and what you will see

Right after sign-in there is a single explanatory screen listing the two permissions the app uses immediately, with one button: **Continue**. It has no skip, no dismiss and no back — pressing Continue always takes you into the iOS camera prompt and then the notifications prompt. Declining either is fine and does not block the app.

Every other permission is requested **only from the action that needs it**:

Permission	Asked when
Photo library	you tap Upload / choose a photo
Location	you open the Costco warehouse picker
Photo library (scan suggestions)	you switch that option on in Profile

If you decline a permission, the app does not re-ask — iOS only prompts once. Instead the relevant screen explains what is unavailable and offers an **Open Settings** button, so there is always a route back.

(2.8.18 was rejected under 5.1.1(iv) because this screen's button read "Allow access" and offered a "Maybe later" that skipped the prompt. Both are gone as of 2.8.19 — see `App_Store_Rejections.md`.)

What each permission is for

- **Camera (NSCameraUsageDescription / android.permission.CAMERA)** — receipt scanning is the core action; required.
- **Photo library (NSPhotoLibraryUsageDescription on iOS; on Android: no permission at all)** — alternate path: importing a pre-existing receipt photo without re-taking it. On Android this goes through the **system photo picker** (expo-image-picker on SDK 55 uses `PickVisualMedia`), which grants per-item access without any media permission — see the stripped list below.
- **Notifications (NSUserNotificationsUsageDescription / POST_NOTIFICATIONS)** — alerting users when a watched item drops in price (the whole product premise).
- **Approximate location (NSLocationWhenInUse / ACCESS_COARSE_LOCATION)** — used only to pick the nearest Costco for in-warehouse price-tag scans. **Coarse only; we do not request precise/fine location.**
- **Background fetch (RECEIVE_BOOT_COMPLETED + WAKE_LOCK)** — expo-task-manager re-registers price-check tasks after device reboot.

We deliberately strip the advertising ID (`AD_ID`), microphone (`RECORD_AUDIO`), precise location (`ACCESS_FINE_LOCATION`) and broad media-read (`READ_MEDIA_IMAGES`, `READ_MEDIA_VIDEO`, `READ_MEDIA_AUDIO`) permissions that our SDKs pull in transitively but the app never uses — so the shipped manifest requests only the permissions listed above. No contacts, no microphone, no precise location, no health data, no advertising ID, no cross-app tracking.

The media-read trio came from `expo-media-library`, whose config plugin Expo autolinks (it is never listed in `app.json`) with a default of `granularPermissions: ['photo','video','audio']`. Version code 20 was flagged under Play's photo-and-video permissions policy for exactly this; version code 21 removes all three at two independent layers — `android.blockedPermissions` in `app.json` (keeps them out of the requested permission set entirely) and `plugins/withAndroidPermissionCleanup.js` (neutralises any dependency manifest that declares them at merge time). Nothing in the app used them: all image picking goes through the system photo picker, and `READ_MEDIA_VISUAL_USER_SELECTED` (the partial-access permission Play sanctions) is kept.

Sign in with Apple (iOS only)

Enabled per App Store guideline 4.8 and offered as the **first** button on the sign-in screen. Hide My Email relay addresses are accepted end to end: the backend verifies Apple's RS256 identity token against Apple's JWKS and keys the account on the `sub` claim, so an account created with a relay address works identically to one with a real address. Nothing in the app requires the real address.

Independence from the retailers we support

PriceBack is an independent app with no relationship to any retailer. Retailer names appear only to identify whose published price-adjustment policy applies to a given receipt, and the in-app store list links to each retailer's own public policy page. We use no retailer logos, wordmarks, or trade dress, the app name and icon reference no retailer, and no retailer's name is used in our App Store keywords. We take no part in any retailer transaction — the user files their claim with the retailer directly.

Account-gated internal tools (nothing hidden)

Four maintainer screens exist in the binary — price-tag review, weekly-flyer ingestion, credit reconciliation, and a barcode↔SKU feeder. They are not hidden features: their Profile entries render only when the **server** reports the signed-in account is on the maintainer allow-list, and every backing endpoint independently rejects non-allow-listed accounts. A reviewer account will not see them and cannot reach them. They are internal data-curation tooling, contain no user-facing functionality, and gate nothing the user has paid for.

Privacy + data rights

- Privacy policy: https://priceback.ca/privacy-policy (English)
- Politique de confidentialité : https://priceback.ca/privacy-fr (Français — for Quebec residents per Law 25 §43)
- Terms of Service: https://priceback.ca/terms-of-service
- Support: https://priceback.ca/support

We comply with PIPEDA (federal), Quebec Law 25, Alberta PIPA, British Columbia PIPA, CCPA, and GDPR. Privacy officer is named in the policy and reachable at privacy@priceback.ca.

The app provides in-app **Download my data** (GDPR Art 20 portability) and **Delete my account** (GDPR Art 17 erasure / Law 25 §28) under Profile.

Third-party services we use

Service	Purpose	Country
Google Cloud Vision	Receipt OCR	US
Google AI Studio (Gemini)	OCR reconciliation when the heuristic parser is inconsistent (opt-in)	US
Sentry	Crash reporting (no PII; payloads scrubbed before send)	US
RevenueCat	Subscription management	US
Railway	Our backend hosting (US-East)	US
Costco Same-Day Delivery	Read-only price scrapes	CA
Best Buy Canada (bestbuy.ca)	Read-only public price lookups, once a day, only for items on receipts users are still tracking	CA

Cross-border transfer disclosed in Privacy Policy §10.

What we DON'T do

Putting these here so a reviewer doesn't have to ask:

- We don't sell or share data with advertisers or data brokers.
- We don't use cross-context behavioural advertising.
- We don't track users across apps or websites (no IDFA / GAID usage).
- We don't have automated decision-making that affects users (no AI-driven pricing decisions, no algorithmic profiling).
- We don't process payments directly — Apple / Google / RevenueCat handle all subscription billing.
- We don't access contacts, calendar, microphone, precise location, or health data. Location is coarse-only, used solely to pick the nearest Costco.

Subscription tiers + credit packs

Purchases are sold on the Canadian App Store only. PriceBack is distributed in Canada, and its in-app purchases exist on the Canadian storefront only. To test a purchase, please use a Sandbox Apple Account whose Country or Region is **Canada** (on the device: Settings → Developer → Sandbox Apple Account). On any other storefront the store returns no products, and the purchase screens say "Purchases are only available in Canada" instead of showing prices.

> Why this is here (2026-09-24): every "no products" event in our crash
>
> reporting since 2.9.0 went live comes from Apple's own test devices —

> US network, Chinese-language UI, iOS 27 — where the Canadian products
>
> correctly do not exist. Canadian devices load all five products at the right
>
> CAD prices. Nothing about the products needs changing; the reviewer needs the
>
> Canadian storefront.

Tested via App Store / Play Store sandbox accounts. RevenueCat is wired end-to-end; subscription entitlements flip the in-app premium flag (unlocks PDF export and email sync), and consumable credit-pack purchases land via the RC `NON_RENEWING_PURCHASE` webhook → backend ledger.

- **Free trial** — 75 credits granted once at install (lifetime allowance, not a monthly reset). Anti-reinstall enforced via device fingerprint on the backend. 1 credit = 1 scan; 75 credits cover up to 75 scans **or** ~$5 of refund claims at the 15 credits / $ rate (or any mix).
- **One-time credit packs** (no expiry) — Starter $3 (250 credits) · Pro $5 (500 credits) · Max $10 (1,100 credits). Same 1 credit = 1 scan math, and claims cost `floor(savings_in_$ × 15)` credits. Larger packs give more credits per dollar (Max is the best value).
- **Unlimited** — auto-renewing subscription, $4.99/mo or $49.99/yr (the annual plan is a discount on twelve monthly payments — no free period is offered; see App_Store_Rejections.md, Guideline 3.1.2(c)). Both cycles unlock: unlimited scans, no per-drop charge, email sync (Gmail + Outlook), PDF export, advanced analytics, priority price checking (every 2 h). **Family Sharing is deliberately off** on both subscriptions in App Store Connect — the app has no family- or device-sharing behaviour, and the paywall no longer claims any (see Bugs_Common_Fixes #135).

There are no grandfathered/legacy subscription tiers: the old monthly Starter/Pro subs and the `priceback_topup_50` pack were removed in migration 0005 (no pre-launch purchases existed), so the paywall shows only the packs and Unlimited above.

The catalog above is the only place we publish it — the canonical definitions live in `shared/pricing.config.js` and every screen, gate, and legal disclosure reads from there.

Price-Drop Guarantee (Unlimited Annual) — not a free trial

For the reviewer: Unlimited Annual includes the *Price-Drop Guarantee*: if PriceBack finds no price drop on the subscriber's receipts during a paid annual year (and they scanned at least 15 receipts, kept the plan and received no refund), **PriceBack's own server** adds one year of Unlimited to their account.

- It is **not** an introductory offer, a free trial, a promotional offer or an offer code. The annual subscription is purchased at its full price; no App Store product carries a free period. The reward is a loyalty benefit granted by our backend after a full paid year — nothing is sold outside In-App Purchase and nothing unlocks paid content bought elsewhere (Guideline 3.1.1).
- In-app copy never says "free" on the purchase surfaces. It reads "*we add another year of Unlimited to your account*" (Guideline 3.1.2(c) — see App_Store_Rejections.md, 2.8.20).
- Because the year is ours and not the store's, the app tells the subscriber, before their renewal date, to turn auto-renew off; the App Store subscription is never modified by us. Full terms: https://priceback.ca/guarantee.

- A reviewer's sandbox purchase never enrols in the guarantee (sandbox transactions are excluded server-side).

Store listing lines (apply at the release that ships the guarantee):

> *EN* — Price-Drop Guarantee: subscribe to Unlimited Annual — if PriceBack finds no price drop on your receipts in your first year, we add another year of Unlimited to your account. Conditions: annual plan, at least 15 receipts scanned in the year, no refund, auto-renew on until we confirm. One guarantee year per account. Full terms at priceback.ca/guarantee.
>
> *FR* — Garantie baisse de prix : abonnez-vous à l'Illimité annuel — si PriceBack ne trouve aucune baisse de prix sur vos reçus durant votre première année, nous ajoutons une autre année d'Illimité à votre compte. Conditions : forfait annuel, au moins 15 reçus numérisés dans l'année, aucun remboursement, renouvellement automatique activé jusqu'à notre confirmation. Une année garantie par compte. Modalités complètes : priceback.ca/guarantee-fr.

Known testing notes

- The first OCR call after install can take 5–10 seconds (cold backend).
- Price refresh can return "no current price" for obscure SKUs that aren't on the Costco Same-Day Delivery catalog. This is expected.
- Best Buy prices are checked once a day, so a newly saved Best Buy receipt shows its first price comparison after the next daily check.
- Push notifications arrive on a once-a-day cron after the receipt is saved. To test push delivery on-demand, the maintainer can hit `POST /api/check-all` on the backend.

Contact for review questions

- Engineering / product: Maxim Lucas — maxim.lucas@viacesi.fr
- Privacy / legal: privacy@priceback.ca
- Security: security@priceback.ca

We respond within 1 business day to reviewer questions.